MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular Examination, October 2025
Third Semester
Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) – MG3DESMG200: SPORTS ECOSYSTEM IN INDIA
(2024 Admission Onwards)
QP Code- 25900646

Duration: 2 Hours
Maximum Marks: 70

Part A: Short Answer Questions — Answer any 10 questions. Each carries 2 marks

Part A – Short Answer Questions (10 × 2 = 20 Marks)

1. Who won India's first individual Olympic medal and in which year?

Answer:
K.D. Jadhav won India's first individual Olympic medal (Bronze) in Wrestling at the 1952 Helsinki Olympics.

2. How do local governments support sports development?

Answer:
Local governments support sports development by:

Providing funding and infrastructure such as stadiums, playgrounds, and training centers.

Organizing grassroots sports programs.

Promoting school and community-level sports events.

Offering scholarships and incentives for athletes.

3. How does political instability affect sports markets?

Answer:
Political instability affects sports markets by:

Reducing investor confidence and sponsorship opportunities.

Disrupting sports events and tourism.

Affecting athlete participation and international relations.

Leading to budget cuts in sports programs.

4. Name one initiative to support para-athletes.

Answer:
One major initiative is the Target Olympic Podium Scheme (TOPS) which includes para-athletes for financial and training support.
Other examples: Paralympic Committee of India (PCI) and Khelo India Para Games.

5. What is a key requirement for an NSF (National Sports Federation) to receive government funding?

Answer:
A key requirement is recognition by the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports (MYAS) and compliance with National Sports Development Code of India, 2011 — including transparency, democratic elections, and good governance.

6. Which Indian state is famous for cricket bat manufacturing?

Answer:
Jammu and Kashmir,and Punjab particularly the Anantnag and Sangam areas, are famous for cricket bat manufacturing using Kashmir willow wood.

7. Define sponsorship in the context of sports funding.

Answer:
Sponsorship is a financial or in-kind support provided by a company or brand to an athlete, team, or event in return for marketing and promotional benefits, such as brand visibility and public relations.

8. Evaluate the strengths of using AI in talent scouting.

Answer:
Strengths of using AI in talent scouting include:

Objective performance analysis using data analytics.

Early identification of emerging talents through predictive algorithms.

Reduction in human bias during selection.

Real-time monitoring of player progress and potential.

9. Who is responsible for athlete welfare and safety?

Answer:

Sports Authority of India (SAI) and National Sports Federations (NSFs) are primarily responsible.

Also, coaches, team managers, and sports medicine units play key roles.

Athlete commissions under organizations like IOA (Indian Olympic Association) ensure welfare and grievance redressal.

10. How does HIL help Indian hockey players?

Answer:
The Hockey India League (HIL) helps Indian hockey players by:

Providing international exposure and high-level competition.

Offering financial rewards and professional contracts.

Improving skills and fitness standards.

Promoting popularity and visibility of hockey in India.

11. What is the role of sports analytics in modern sports management?

Answer: Sports analytics involves the collection and interpretation of data related to athletes' performance, team efficiency, fan engagement, and financial operations.

Performance Optimization: Helps coaches design training programs, track fatigue, and improve tactics.

Injury Prevention: Identifies physical stress patterns to minimize injuries.

Talent Scouting: Uses metrics to assess potential players.

Strategic Decision-Making: Assists in game strategy and substitution decisions.

Fan Engagement & Marketing: Data insights enhance ticket sales, sponsorship, and fan experience.

Example: IPL franchises use data analytics for player selection and in-game decision-making.

12. Explain the impact of poor sports governance on public trust.

Answer: Poor sports governance—marked by corruption, lack of transparency, and mismanagement—damages public confidence in sports organizations.

Loss of Credibility: Fans and sponsors withdraw support.

Reduced Participation: Athletes and youth lose motivation.

Financial Misuse: Misallocation of funds affects sports infrastructure.

Scandals & Match-Fixing: Create distrust in fair play.

Example: Scandals in organizations like FIFA and Indian cricket have led to governance reforms.

PART B – Short Essay Questions (Answer any 6 × 5 = 30 Marks)

13. How did cricket evolve as a national passion in India?

Answer:

Introduced by the British during colonial rule.

Indian teams formed in the early 1900s; 1932 marked India's first Test match.

Major turning points:

1983 World Cup victory ignited national pride.

Liberalization in the 1990s brought TV coverage and sponsorships.

IPL (2008 onwards) turned cricket into a mass entertainment industry.

Cricket now transcends class and region—seen as a unifying national identity.

14. Examine the importance of grassroots-level scouting in India.

Answer: Grassroots scouting identifies young talent early, ensuring sustainable athletic development.

Talent Identification: Detects potential players at school and village levels.

Skill Development: Provides access to basic training, coaching, and facilities.

Inclusivity: Reaches rural and underprivileged athletes.

Long-term Benefits: Builds a strong talent pipeline for national teams.

Example: Programs like Khelo India and Mission XI Million support grassroots scouting.

15. Analyze how a brand has built its global presence using athlete endorsements.

Answer: Example: Nike

Partners with iconic athletes like Michael Jordan, Serena Williams, and Cristiano Ronaldo.

Athletes serve as brand ambassadors, linking performance and trust.

Endorsements increase emotional appeal and credibility.

Social media amplifies athlete influence globally.

Result: Nike evolved from a sportswear brand into a symbol of excellence and empowerment.

16. How do corporate partnerships influence grassroots sports?

Answer:

Funding & Infrastructure: Corporates build training centers and sponsor events.

CSR Initiatives: Support youth sports and rural talent (e.g., Reliance Foundation Youth Sports).

Skill Development: Provide training, nutrition, and mentorship programs.

Brand Image: Enhances corporate goodwill and visibility.

Example: Tata Trusts' support for football academies has boosted grassroots sports.

17. Discuss the importance of SSA (Sports and Safety Authority) regulations in maintaining fair play.

Answer:

Anti-Doping Measures: Prevents performance enhancement through banned substances.

Safety Standards: Ensures athlete health and safe sports environments.

Ethical Guidelines: Upholds integrity and sportsmanship.

Disciplinary Actions: Penalizes cheating, match-fixing, or misconduct.

Fair Competition: Creates equal opportunities for all participants.

Example: The World Anti-Doping Agency (WADA) and India's NADA implement such regulations.

18. Analyze the role of sports leagues like IPL and ISL in retail growth.

Answer:

Merchandise Sales: Team jerseys, caps, and accessories boost retail revenues.

Brand Collaborations: Retail chains partner with leagues for promotions.

Fan Engagement: Sports events drive spending on electronics, apparel, and beverages.

Economic Multiplier Effect: Boosts tourism, hospitality, and food industries.

Example: IPL's merchandising has become a multi-billion-rupee retail ecosystem.

19. Evaluate the role of media rights in shaping the competitive balance and financial landscape of major sports leagues.

Answer:

Revenue Source: Broadcasting rights generate major income for teams and leagues.

Economic Power: Influences player salaries and team budgets.

Competitive Balance: Uneven revenue sharing can create imbalance.

Global Reach: Expands audience and brand visibility.

Example: BCCI's 2023 IPL media rights worth ₹48,390 crore boosted the league's global value.

20. Analyze the competitive strategies of Sony and Star Sports in India.

Answer:

Star Sports: Focuses on exclusivity (IPL, ICC events), multilingual coverage, and Disney+ Hotstar streaming.

Sony Sports: Invests in diverse sports (football, wrestling, tennis) to capture niche audiences.

Competition: Price wars for rights, marketing innovation, and OTT expansion.

Result: Viewers benefit from enhanced content quality and accessibility.

PART C – Essay Questions (Answer any 2 × 10 = 20 Marks)

21. Examine the challenges in implementing sports policies in India.

Answer:

Fragmented Governance: Overlapping roles between central and state authorities.

Inadequate Funding: Limited allocation for non-cricket sports.

Poor Infrastructure: Rural areas lack basic facilities.

Corruption & Bureaucracy: Hinders timely execution.

Lack of Accountability: Policies often fail due to poor monitoring.
Example: National Sports Policy (2001) and Khelo India initiatives aim to fix these gaps.

Suggestions: Strengthen governance, increase private participation, and ensure transparent fund use.

22. Analyze the challenges and opportunities for the ISL in establishing a sustainable and successful professional football league in India.

Answer: Challenges:

Low grassroots participation.

Limited fan following compared to cricket.

Financial instability of smaller clubs.

Opportunities:

Global exposure via international partnerships (e.g., La Liga, Premier League).

Corporate investment and media coverage.

Development of local talent through academies.

Expanding digital fan engagement.

Conclusion: With continued investment, ISL can become Asia's leading football league.

23. Examine the role of sports events in promoting social change and addressing global issues like gender equality, racial justice, and environmental sustainability.

Answer:

Gender Equality: Women's leagues (like WPL) empower female athletes.

Racial Justice: Campaigns like "Black Lives Matter" highlight inclusion.

Environmental Sustainability: Green sports stadiums, waste management, and carbon-neutral events.

Social Unity: Sports transcend barriers, fostering peace and cooperation.

Example: 2012 London Olympics emphasized sustainability and inclusion.

24. Critically examine whether India's current sports infrastructure matches global standards.

Answer: Current Status:

Major cities have world-class stadiums (e.g., Narendra Modi Stadium, Kalinga Stadium).

Rural areas still face lack of basic facilities, coaching, and maintenance.

Dependence on government funding delays projects.

Comparison with Global Standards:

India lags in sports science, technology, and athlete support systems.

Limited integration of data analytics, recovery labs, and nutrition centers.